



Figure 7: QJackCtl

You can use other text editors like nano or gvim instead of Gedit.

We have to add this line at the end of the file:

```
source /etc/timidity/fluidr3_gm.cfg
```

But the file probably contains that line already, in a commented state. All you have to do is uncomment it [by removing the hash (#) in front of it]. After that, you may comment the line of the current soundfont by adding a '#' before it. Now TiMidity++ starts using the new soundfont.

When you use multiple soundfonts and when they contain the same instrument, the last soundfont is used. For advanced mixing of soundfonts, you can edit their configuration files (e.g., `/etc/timidity/fluidr3_gm.cfg`) or create a new soundfont using programs like Swami.

When MIDI blocks everything else

Some MIDI programs may suspend all other audio playbacks. The suspension usually ends once the program is closed. If it doesn't, you may try killing the *jackd* process.

You can stop *jackd* using QJackCtl or the facilities provided by *System Monitor* under the *Processes* tab. However, if you prefer the command line way, use the following command to get the process ID (PID) of *jackd* (the second column of the output shows the PID):

```
lsuf|grep /usr/bin/jackd
```

Now you can run the following command (replacing PID with the actual value) to kill *jackd*:

```
kill PID
```

Other packages worth trying

Here is a list of some useful packages that you should try.

GNU Denemo: Denemo is a score writer that acts as a GUI for LilyPond, a format and program for music engraving. Multiple input methods including vocal note entry are supported.

ZynAddSubFX: This is a synthesiser that produces sound for MIDI input using mathematical calculations rather than



Figure 8: Screenshot of Musix (Marcos Germán Guglielmetti / commons.wikimedia.org, under GFDL 1.2+).

depending on a soundfont. Although this sounds unrealistic, it can give an electronic touch to your music.

FMIT: This is a free software tuning program that can be used to tune your instrument or your voice itself.

GNU Solfege: Solfege is a wonderful program that provides many types of training exercises to tune your ears to music. It also tracks your performance and produces live statistics.

Libre music online

There are a lot of websites that host music under free licences. But in order to learn the process, you have to visit each application's website.

If you'd like to get everything related to free music production under a single site, just visit *libremusicproduction.com*. This is an exclusive website that hosts articles and news related to free music production software, which will be really useful for a composer.

Music distros

Thanks to applications like Synaptic and Ubuntu Software Centre, package installation has been made a simple task in most GNU/Linux distros. But installing all the packages we have discussed here would be a time-consuming process. Also, their configuration may get a little bit technical. However, there are some GNU/Linux distros focusing on multimedia production that are of help here. They include Ubuntu Studio, Musix and dyne:bolic.

Whether you choose to go the distro way or the manual way, I'm pretty sure that with free software, you'll get the thrill of setting up a music studio and creating your own magical beats! 🎧

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